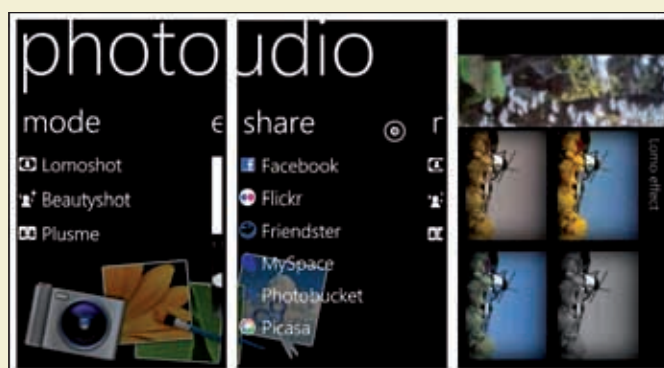


to first expose the shot and cover the lens only after the lightning strikes. This is mainly because it happens so fast that you may not have time to respond, and also, lightning strikes are so bright that you'll get most of the scene in that flash anyway. This method requires plenty of trial and error, but that's what digital cameras are best at, reviewing and discarding unwanted images at no cost!

Making use of apps

Mobile phones and similar mobile devices are quite badly crippled when it comes to image quality. Such devices, however, have lots of creative potential. The apps alone add a whole new dimension to your device



Samsung PhotoStudio

convenient if you want to keep important documents such as your driving license and passport handy at all times. All of these items can be neatly sorted and indexed by this app.

Samsung's "PhotoStudio" is another interesting app. Avail-

Unleashing your creativity

One of the biggest advantages of a mobile phone camera is that it's always with you. Also, mobile phones are usually quite rugged as they're designed to withstand the daily abuse we



Handyscan

and can completely change the way you work with a mobile phone camera.

Take "Handyscan" for instance. This app is available for iOS, Android and WP7. A very simple app, it allows you to take images and convert them to a .pdf format. The paid version even works as an OCR software, allowing you to actually extract the text and save it. How is this useful? You can save everything from restaurant menus, bills and receipts to addresses, quotations and newspaper articles, etc., for quick reference. Also



Helmet mounted cams need not be so complicated

able on Samsung's own Android and Mango devices, this is an app you can have a lot of fun with. Other than allowing you to directly share images on Photobucket and Picasa web albums, this app comes with a host of editing tools and some very interesting scene modes, including a panorama mode which actually works. "Dreamshot" is an interesting mode which allows you to insert an image in a fixed template, so, you can have your friend's face on the cover of a newspaper, for example.

subject them to. You can use this to your advantage when experimenting with such devices.

For the bespectacled among you there's a very simple solution in case you misplace your spectacles. Grab your phone, turn on the camera, hold it in front of you at a distance at which you can see the screen clearly and there you have it, a little window of clarity in that foggy world you call your vision!

A mobile phone can be converted into an effective little spy camera as well. For this, you

can use an old camera phone if you have one rotting in some old cupboard. Rip the body apart, leaving just the essentials intact. Design your own custom housing and use software such as SmartCam to wirelessly stream to a PC directly. Attach a string and flashlight to it and you can send your phone where no phone has gone before, down shafts, inside the engine compartment of your car, anywhere you like. For a really wild ride, you can throw it into washing machine, after placing it in a waterproof plastic bag of course. You can even stick the camera under the wheel arches of your car or bike or even on your helmet. The possibilities are endless.

It's even possible to hack your old phone and convert it into a reversing camera for a car. Use the same process as above. Rip apart the camera, leave the essentials, use SmartCam or something similar and turn on your phone and camera. You should now be able to wirelessly stream video to a mobile phone or laptop in your car.

WINDOWS PHONE 7

Microsoft, and even Nokia for that matter, have been pushing Windows Phone as the next big thing. The platform is still quite new and some of you may have trouble switching. For those of you who have taken the plunge and got yourself a spanking new WP7 device, here are some tips and tricks to get you started.

Managing contacts

Transferring contacts from your old device to a Windows Phone can be a slow and painstaking process, or a hassle free, 2 minute job.

WP7 uses "cloud storage" for handling contacts, much like Android. It doesn't interface with your PC and neither